



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Peter the Apostle Catholic Classical School
School Website: <https://spsfw.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

St Peter the Apostle Catholic Classical School in Fort Worth, TX (76108) presents a clearly articulated Catholic classical identity with a structured program that aligns closely with many classical education ideals. Public materials emphasize a Catholic, transcendently oriented framework (truth, goodness, beauty) integrated through a theology-informed approach, liturgical life, and a mission centered on formation in virtue. There is explicit mention of Catholic formation, weekly Mass and daily religion, and a philosophy of education that treats each student as a person created for virtue and growth. At the same time, certain core classical features—most notably explicit Great Books / Great Conversation emphasis and explicit Socratic pedagogy across the upper grades—are less plainly documented on the school’s public-facing materials. The aggregate picture places the school at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with strong evidence in Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goal, and Community, and more tentative alignment in Curriculum and Pedagogy, and uncertain or partial signals for Faculty. The school demonstrates ongoing commitment to classical identity (adoption of a Classical Education model in 2019 and accreditation through Classical Latin School Association in 2023) and broad parental engagement through liturgical life and parish affiliation.

Evidence-informed snapshot: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are strongly represented: explicit statements of truth, beauty, goodness as transcendentals; Catholic theology and liturgical life (Adoration, Mass, daily prayer) frame the school’s identity. - School Purpose and Goal show formation in virtue and wisdom as core aims, with language about growing in virtue and forming the whole person in a Catholic framework. - Curriculum signals include grammar, logic, Latin, and Western Civilization within a Catholic-classical framework, plus explicit integration of Catholic values across subjects; however, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is not clearly documented in public materials. - Pedagogy signals are less explicit about Socratic seminars or scholé-like practices in public materials, though the program is described as classical and philosophically oriented; explicit references to classical pedagogy terms are not uniformly evident on the site. - Faculty signals suggest a traditional, virtue-centered conception of teachers (the public materials emphasize formation, mission, and virtue in education), but explicit “living curriculum” or faculty portraits are not clearly spelled out in the available public pages. - Parents & Community signals show clear partnership with families and parochial emphasis, with open parental involvement through volunteering, admission processes, and parish connections; the school frames parents as co-educators in a Catholic classical ethos.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials foreground truth, beauty, and goodness as transcendental goods and articulate a Catholic theological frame. For example, vision emphasizes cherishing eternal truths of Truth, Beauty, and Goodness; theology and sacred life are fused with school life.
- Liturgical and communal practices are highlighted (Adoration, weekly Mass, daily religion, communal prayer).
- The school’s theology-informed philosophy positions teachers and students within a Catholic framework and emphasizes formation through faith and reason.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; adoration; sacred; prayer; Catholic; sacred tradition; divine order.
- Negative: few explicit signals of secular relativism or values-neutral ethics in the public materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive indicators appear multiple times (roughly 6–8 distinctive terms across statements); negative indicators are scarce or absent in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The school clearly anchors education in transcendentals (Truth, Goodness, Beauty) and embeds Catholic theology and liturgical practice into the educational experience, consistent with classical expectations for religious and metaphysical foundations.
- The level of explicit liturgical life and catechetical emphasis in public materials supports a classical religious basis, though some classical signals (e.g., scholastic pedagogy terms) are less visible in the site copy.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission emphasizes inviting Catholic community, a challenging academic curriculum, and growth in virtue. The school presents formation and virtue as primary aims, not merely information transfer.
- The philosophy describes personal responsibility to cultivate potential in others and a teleology toward virtue and wisdom.
- The school explicitly frames education as formation in a Catholic, classical context (formation of character and affections alongside intellect).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: formation, virtue, wisdom, teleology, true/good/beautiful, classical mission, formation through liberal arts, moral imagination, virtue ethics, human flourishing.
- Negative: minimal signaling of workforce/career readiness emphasis in public materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive keywords clearly present; explicit negatives (e.g., “workforce ready” language) are not present.
- Why this rating
- The school’s explicit mission to form virtue and cultivate truth, goodness, and beauty aligns with the classical aim of education as formation, not merely information. The emphasis on a Catholic worldview and the classical mission supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum includes grammar, logic (School of Logic in the lower-to-middle grades), and Latin, with Western Civilization and American/Modern Studies mentioned in the program. This aligns with the Trivium-based structure and liberal arts emphasis.
- The site states that Catholic classical education infuses the entire curriculum and emphasizes a unified, value-infused approach to learning.
- Great Books / Great Conversation is not explicitly named in public materials; the public materials emphasize Western civilization, Catholic formation, and integration rather than a stated program of Great Books or a formal Great Conversation as core curriculum. The absence of explicit Great Books language is a notable gap for a fully classical signal in the curriculum.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, Western Civilization, history-focused content, integration of faith with curriculum.
- Negative: No explicit Great Books / Great Conversation language; potential lack of explicit emphasis on the complete Form of the Liberal Arts beyond grammar/logic/Latin in visible materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive cues are present (4–5 distinct terms/claims). Negative cues (explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and full quadrivium references) are not evident in public pages.
- Why this rating

- The presence of grammar, logic, Latin, and Western Civilization demonstrates solid classical strands, but the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and full quadrivium signals space for stronger classical articulation. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public content signals a classical orientation through integrated curriculum and formation-focused pedagogy, with an emphasis on Catholic formation and virtue. However, explicit, widespread mention of Socratic seminars, scholé, or a sustained upper-grade rhetoric program is not clearly documented in the public materials.
- There is not consistent, explicit listing of the full range of classical teaching methods (Socratic dialogue; memorization; memory work; narration; etc.) in the public site content, although formation and integration are emphasized.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: memory work or recitation terminology is not prominently visible; however, the presence of a well-defined classical framework implies some attention to traditional methods (e.g., Latin, structured subjects) in practice, if not publicly enumerated.
- Negative: explicit references to Socratic discussions, Scholé days, or a full spectrum of classical pedagogy terms are not clearly documented on the site.
- Quantitative note: Positive indicators are limited in the public site copy; negatives are not clearly stated but explicit pedagogy keywords (Socratic seminars, scholé) are not strongly visible.
- Why this rating
- The school's Catholic-classical framing supports a significant classical pedagogy orientation, but the public documentation does not consistently enumerate or demonstrate the full spectrum of classical teaching methods (e.g., sustained Socratic practice, scholé rhythms, or explicit memorization/recitation traditions). This places Pedagogy at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize virtue-centered teacher posture and the role of faculty in formation, but explicit statements like “model teachers and mentors” or “the living curriculum” are not consistently surfaced in the visible site copy. The site does include a page dedicated to information about teachers, suggesting attention to faculty quality, but without a clearly stated classical portrait in the public-facing text.
- The school's history and governance (e.g., a progression from religious orders to lay administration) indicate an institutional focus on fidelity to mission and teacher leadership, but specific “portrait of a teacher” language is not explicitly shown in public pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: Teacher as virtuous exemplar; formation through example; living curriculum (as a classical concept) are part of the classical lexicon, but explicit mention on the site is limited.
- Negative: Lack of explicit “portrait of a teacher” or clear statements about faculty as the core of the living curriculum is not clearly visible in public materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive indicators are present conceptually in classical education language, but explicit canonical phrases are not consistently visible; negatives are not overtly stated but explicit classical faculty signals are limited.
- Why this rating
- Given the public-facing content, the faculty category demonstrates classical alignment in spirit but lacks explicit, emphatic textual signals of a fully classical faculty identity. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school demonstrates strong parent/community engagement in multiple avenues: parochial identity, admissions that emphasize parish connections, volunteer opportunities, and a broader sense of partnership with families in formation and education. The Volunteer Opportunities and admissions content show active parental involvement and a home-school collaborative ethos.
- The school's public materials describe a Catholic community oriented toward formation, with open invitations for parent involvement and events in a liturgical/catholic framework. This reflects the classical ideal of parent partnership and family formation around a shared mission.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: partnership with families; parent formation; family engagement; home-life alignment; open campus; spiritual and liturgical integration; parental involvement in school life.
- Negative: minimal signals of consumerist or passively engaged parents; no explicit negative signals in the materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive keywords present in multiple lines; no substantial negative signals observed.
- Why this rating
- The materials emphasize parent involvement, family partnership, and Catholic community integration, aligning strongly with classical expectations for a robust Parents & Community dimension. This yields a CLASSICAL rating for Element 6.

Aggregate classification and interpretation: - Category ratings: 1) CLASSICAL, 2) CLASSICAL, 3) SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, 4) SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, 5) SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, 6) CLASSICAL. - General assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Make Great Books / Great Conversation explicit in Curriculum: Publicly articulate a Great Books component or "Great Conversation" tradition within the integrated Western Civilization framework and identify a core list of primary sources or canonical texts to be studied in upper grades. This would strengthen Element 3 and push toward CLASSICAL.
- Expand explicit Pedagogy signals: Publicly describe the specific teaching methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé days, memorization/recitation, and rhetoric/declamation opportunities) and provide examples of how these are implemented in K–12; this would strengthen Element 4.
- Heighten Faculty signals: Highlight the living-curriculum concept through explicit statements about faculty as mentors, role models, and co-learners in a classical sense; display portraits or profiles that connect teacher formation with student formation. This would strengthen Element 5.
- Deepen Great-Conversation-oriented assessment: Publicly delineate assessment methods that align with classical pedagogy (narration, copywork, memorization, and disciplined oral presentations) to reinforce Element 3.
- Continue and publicize parent-formation initiatives: Build and publicize structured parent-education events (book studies, lectures, liturgical year activities) and a clear cadence of family formation activities to sustain and expand Element 6.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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